Corpus: the Mesopotamian Creation Stories → Hebrew

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Read `../translation-guidelines.md` first, then this file, then the shared `renderings.md`, then the project's own `project.md`.

Goal (the user's plan, 2026-10-16)

Translate the Mesopotamian creation texts that matter most for **Genesis 1–3**, the block the commentary is working on now (Gen 1, the fifth day: the *tanninim*).
The corpus is the counterpart of the flood corpus (`../סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/`), and it inherits that corpus's conventions and shared renderings.
It comes from items 1–2 of `../curated-translation-candidates.md` and the relevance survey (`../curation-surveys/relevance-survey--2026-10-16.md`, §A 1–7).

The user's standing decisions (from the flood corpus) apply here too:

- partial niqqud (guidelines §6.2): names at first occurrence and ambiguous words;
- deities are never assimilated to biblical names; biblical place names are used for places the Bible names (Babylon = `בָּבֶל`).

The texts and how they relate

#	Project folder	Text	Language, date	Relation to Genesis
1	`1--אנומה אליש/`	**Enūma eliš**, Tablets I–VII (1,098 lines), the Babylonian Epic of Creation	Akkadian, SB; composed probably under Nebuchadnezzar I (late 12th cent. BCE); mss 9th–2nd cent. BCE	The main external control for Gen 1:1–2:3: Tiāmat / `תְּהוֹם`, the mingled waters, the sky made from half of Tiāmat, the eleven monsters ↔ the *tanninim*, the stars and the calendar ↔ the luminaries, man made from a god's blood ↔ Gen 1:26–28, the gods' rest ↔ 2:1–3, naming as rule, Babylon's bricks ↔ Gen 11, Marduk's bow ↔ Gen 9:13.
2	`2--טקסטי בריאה-ועדן/`	**Creation and Eden companions**: Adapa (eBL `L/1/7`, MB + SB); Enki and Ninmaḫ (ETCSL 1.1.2); the Song of the Hoe (ETCSL 5.5.4); Enki and Ninḫursaĝ (ETCSL 1.1.1); the bilingual "Creation of the World by Marduk" (CT 13 35–38; King 1902, check eBL/CDLI); KAR 4 (the creation of man from the Lamga gods' blood; check SEAL); the cosmogonic prologue of Grain and Sheep (ETCSL 5.3.2)	Sumerian, Akkadian, bilingual; OB–NB	Gen 2–3: man from clay / from the ground (2:7, 3:19), the "not yet" chain (2:4b–5), the work of the garden (2:15), the bread and water of life refused (3:22), Dilmun ↔ Eden, the forbidden plants and the curse, Nin-ti and the rib (debated), primeval humans without bread or clothing (Gen 2–4). About 1,000 lines in all.

#	Project folder	Text	Language, date	Relation to Genesis
3	3--הציפור והדג/	**The Debate between Bird and Fish** (ETCSL 5.3.5; 189 lines)	Sumerian, OB copies (c. 1800 BCE) of an Ur III composition (Šulgi)	**Gen 1:20–23, the fifth day**: Enki settles fish and birds together in the marsh and "fills" the reeds with them (1:20, 22); the bird "flying in heaven, walking on earth" (1:20); a Sumerian characterization of the two creatures; the verdict for the bird by its voice. Added 2026-10-19 (round 2, run 1).
4	4--אנקי וסדר-העולם/	**Enki and the World Order** (ETCSL 1.1.3 = ORACC Q000334; 465 lines, ~31% damaged)	Sumerian, OB	The world ordered by allotment: days, months, years (1:14); fish and birds of the marsh (1:20–22); rain (2:5); borders and dwellings for the gods (Deut 32:8); farmer, shepherd, brick, builder, metalworker, drums, weaving as gods' offices (Gen 4:17–22; 11:3–4); Inana without a portion (Deut 10:9). Added 2026-10-19.

#	Project folder	Text	Language, date	Relation to Genesis
5	5--הוראות האיכר/	**The Farmer's Instructions** (ETCSL 5.6.3 = ORACC Q000784; 111 lines)	Sumerian, OB copies (the composition perhaps Ur III)	Farming as a god's instruction ("the instruction of Ninurta", 110) ↔ Isa 28:23–29; [divergence] with Gen 3:17–19 and 9:20; the plough-team (Deut 22:10), the threshing ox (Deut 25:4), the gleaners and the threshing floor (Lev 19:9; Ruth 2–3), mice, locust and grain disease (1 Sam 6; Deut 28:22). Added 2026-10-22 (Round 3, run 1).
6	6--המעדר והמחרשה/	**The Debate between Hoe and Plough** (ETCSL 5.3.1; 201 entries; ORACC has no text)	Sumerian, OB	The work of the ground (Gen 2:5, 2:15, 3:23); the garden, the well and the watering (2:8–10); bricks, city and tower (4:17; 11:3–4); a catastrophe, the god's not-abandoning, then "summer and winter" (H&P 166–175 ↔ 8:21–22); the gleaning orphan and widow (Lev 19:9–10; Deut 24:19). Added 2026-10-22.

#	Project folder	Text	Language, date	Relation to Genesis
7	7--הקיץ והחורף/	**The Debate between Summer and Winter** (ETCSL 5.3.3 = ORACC Q000762; 295 entries, ~⅓ damaged)	Sumerian, OB; set at the Ur III court of Ibbi-Suen	**Gen 8:22** (the seasons decreed as fates; but begotten by Enlil on the mountain); Gen 1:20–22 (fish and birds born together); **Gen 4:2–8** (two brothers, two gifts, one verdict – for the farmer); Gen 33:3–11 and Ps 133 (the bow, the gifts, brotherhood "like fresh oil"). Added 2026-10-22.

Reading order for the commentary: for the fifth day (Gen 1:20–23, the unit now being edited) start with 3 (Bird and Fish) and EWO 250–308 and 89–99; then 1 (Tablets I, IV, V, VI first), then 2 (for Gen 2–3: Adapa, Enki and Ninḫursaĝa, Grain and Sheep, the Founding of Eridu; for Gen 1:26 and man's work: KAR 4, Enki and Ninmaḫ, the Song of the Hoe; for Ex 4:11 and Lev 21: Enki and Ninmaḫ 51–101).

Atra-ḫasīs I (the creation of man from clay and a slain god's flesh and blood) is already translated in the flood corpus (`../סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/1-אתרחסיס/`). Its creation rows are cross-referenced in this corpus's `parallels-index.md`, so that the Gen 1–2 evidence is in one place.

Shared conventions for this corpus

- **`renderings.md` in this folder is shared by all projects of the corpus.** It inherits the flood corpus's shared renderings (`../סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/renderings.md`) as its default: divine names, formulas and key terms are the same in both corpora, so that a reader can compare, for example, the creation of man in Enūma eliš VI with Atra-ḫasīs I. It adds the creation-specific names and terms.
- **Shared lines get identical Hebrew.** Enūma eliš repeats long passages (Tiāmat's army four times in I–III; Marduk's conditions three times; Anšar's messages). Identical Akkadian gets identical Hebrew, verified by script (guidelines §6.1).
- A project translator does not edit the shared file during drafting; proposals go into the project's `project.md`, and the corpus coordinator merges them.

- **Parallels index:** each project keeps its index (guidelines §7.3). `parallels-index.md` here merges them into one table ordered by Bible verse. This is the main product for the commentary.

Status

#	Project	Status
1	Enūma eliš I–VII	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-16: 1,098 lines (I 162, II 162, III 138, IV 146, V 158, VI 166, VII 166), each tablet with three review passes; repeated lines verified by script (`verify.py`); `translation.rtl.md` generated (`build_translation.py`); print stub `../-1/הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/אנומה-אליש.rtl.md`. Open decisions for the user: `1-אנומה-אליש/project.md`.
2	Creation and Eden companions	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-17: seven texts, 1,076 lines – Adapa (MB 78 + SB 97), Enki and Ninḫursaĝa 305, Enki and Ninmaḫ 142, Song of the Hoe 110, Grain and Sheep 193, Founding of Eridu (BM 93014) 67, KAR 4 84 – drafted text by text by sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by `verify.py`; `translation.rtl.md` generated (`build_translation.py`); parallels merged into `parallels-index.md`; renderings merged into `renderings.md` §5; print stub `../הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה/המסופוטמיים/2-טקסטי-בריאה-ועדן.rtl.md`. Open decisions: end of `2--טקסטי בריאה-ועדן/project.md`.
3	Bird and Fish	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-19: all 189 lines, one sequential sub-agent, three review passes, verified by `sumerian_tools.py verify 3 --strict`; `translation.rtl.md` generated (`sumerian_tools.py build 3`); 84 parallels rows; print stub `../הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/3-הציפור-והדג.rtl.md`. Open decisions: `3-הציפור-והדג/project.md`.
4	Enki and the World Order	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-19: all 465 lines in two files (`annotated-2.rtl.md` 250–472 first, then `annotated-1.rtl.md` 1–249), two sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified (`verify 4 --strict`); translation generated (`build 4`); 171 parallels rows; print stub `../הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/4-אנקי-וסדר-העולם.rtl.md`. Open decisions 1–38: `4-אנקי-וסדר-העולם/project.md`.
5	The Farmer's Instructions	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-22: 111 lines, one sub-agent (third of the run), three review passes, verified (`sumerian_tools.py verify 5 --strict`); translation generated (`build 5`); 55 parallels rows; print stub `../הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/5-הוראות-האיכר.rtl.md`. Open decisions: `5-הוראות-האיכר/project.md`.
6	Hoe and Plough	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-22: 201 entries, one sub-agent (second of the run), three review passes, verified (`verify 6 --strict`); translation generated (`build 6`); 96 parallels rows; print stub `../הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/6-המעדר-והמחרשה.rtl.md`. Open decisions: `6-המעדר-והמחרשה/project.md`.

#	Project	Status
7	Summer and Winter	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-22: 295 entries, one sub-agent (first of the run), three review passes, verified (`verify 7 --strict`); translation generated (`build 7`); ~100 parallels rows; print stub `../הדפסה/סיפורי-הקיץ-והחורף/7-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים.rtl.md`. Open decisions: `7--הקיץ והחורף/project.md`.

Corpus-level files

File	What
`renderings.md`	Shared renderings, binding for all projects.
`translator-brief--sumerian.md`	The common brief for Sumerian translators (projects 3–4; reusable).
`translator-brief--sumerian--5-7.md`, `...--shared-lemmas.txt`	The run brief of projects 5–7 (Round 3, run 1: one translator per text, one at a time) and the lemmas the three texts share.
`sumerian_tools.py`	`verify KEY` / `build KEY` / `grep all '<regex>'` for projects 3–7 (5–7 with their own gates, renderings §9) (coverage against ETCSL, reserved strings with the Sumerian word that licenses them, name traps, identical lines; the clean translation generated from the annotated `>` lines).
`parallels-index.md`	The projects' parallels indexes merged, ordered by Bible verse, with "Key findings for the commentary" for each project at the top. Regenerate with `python3 -I 1-אנומה-אלישbuild_parallels_index.py` (reads all seven projects).

Notes from the planning of project 2 (done; kept for reference)

- Use the shared renderings: *banû* = בָּנָה, *ṭiṭṭu* = טִיט, *lullû* = לַדְמוֹן, *awīlu* = אָדָם, *dullu* = עָמָל, *šīmtu* = גּוֹרָל, *Apsû* = (הָ)אַפְסוּ, *nabû* (to name) = קָרָא (בְּשֵׁם), Sumerian *edin* = עֲרָבָה (never עֵדֶן).
- Enki = אֶנְקִי / Ea = אֵאָה; Ninmaḫ = נִינְמַח; Ninḫursaĝ = נִין־חַרְסַגָּה (flood corpus); Nintu = נִינְתּוּ; Adapa = אֲדָפָה.
- Enūma eliš VI 1–38 (man from Qingu's blood) and the Atra-ḫasīs creation scene are the comparison points for KAR 4 and Enki and Ninmaḫ.